School of Innovation and Management (SoIM)

Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM)

Course Outline | **PGDM (2025-27)** | **Trimester – IV**

Course Code: 407MM2	Course Name: Marketing Research	Course Credits: 03

Faculty: Dr. Samala Nagaraj
Email.ID: samala.nagaraj@soim.edu.in

Course Coverage:

Building upon foundational Business Research Methods (BRM) covered in earlier trimesters, this advanced specialization elective course focuses exclusively on contemporary Marketing Research. In today's digital, data-driven economy, marketing decision-makers require sophisticated insights to navigate complex consumer behavior, brand equity dynamics, omnichannel touchpoints, and digital attribution.

This course provides rigorous, advanced training in designing and executing domain-specific marketing research projects. Students will explore cutting-edge methodologies including neuromarketing, biometric and eye-tracking measures, social listening, sentiment analysis, digital footprint analytics, advanced multivariate segmentation and positioning models (Conjoint Analysis, Multidimensional Scaling, Structural Equation Modeling), brand health tracking, and customer lifetime value (CLV) estimation.

Through applied industry projects, live secondary data sets, and advanced analytical toolkits, students gain the expertise required to lead marketing intelligence functions in top-tier organizations.

Course Objectives:

1. To critically evaluate advanced marketing research designs, measurement theories, and scaling techniques tailored specifically to capture complex consumer psychological and behavioral constructs.
2. To master cutting-edge qualitative and netnographic research methods, including digital ethnography, social listening, sentiment analysis, and online community intelligence.
3. To execute advanced quantitative multivariate data analysis techniques crucial for marketing strategy, including Conjoint Analysis for product design, Multidimensional Scaling (MDS) for brand positioning, and Factor/Cluster Analysis for advanced market segmentation.
4. To explore emerging physiological and neurological research paradigms, including neuromarketing tools (EEG, fMRI, eye-tracking, biometric galvanic skin response) to measure subconscious consumer emotional and cognitive responses.
5. To design, implement, and present a comprehensive, enterprise-grade marketing research consultancy project addressing a real-world brand, pricing, digital attribution, or market expansion challenge.

Course Learning Outcomes:

After completing the course, student should be able to: Five points for 1.5 Credit Course and Ten points for 3 Credit course

1. Formulate precise, actionable marketing research problems and hypotheses derived from strategic marketing audit failures and market opportunities. (Aligned with PLO1 & PLO6)
2. Design advanced quantitative survey instruments incorporating multi-item psychometric scales, multi-attribute attitude models, and experimental research designs. (Aligned with PLO1 & PLO5)
3. Conduct digital netnographic investigations, social media sentiment tracking, and text mining on unstructured customer feedback data. (Aligned with PLO3 & PLO5)
4. Apply advanced multivariate data techniques (Conjoint Analysis, Cluster Analysis, Discriminant Analysis, and MDS) using statistical software to solve product, pricing, and positioning problems. (Aligned with PLO1 & PLO6)
5. Interpret neurological and biometric research data (eye-tracking heatmaps, EEG engagement indices) to evaluate advertising creative and packaging effectiveness. (Aligned with PLO3 & PLO6)
6. Evaluate digital marketing attribution models, website clickstream data analytics, and customer lifetime value (CLV) predictive models. (Aligned with PLO1 & PLO3)
7. Execute an end-to-end specialized marketing research consultancy project for an industry partner or simulated brand. (Aligned with PLO3)
8. Demonstrate collaborative leadership in managing cross-functional research teams, coordinating data collection, and synthesizing insights under tight deadlines. (Aligned with PLO4)
9. Access and critically appraise contemporary academic journals in marketing science and industry whitepapers (WARC, Gartner, Forrester) to solve novel market problems. (Aligned with PLO4)
10. Communicate complex statistical findings and strategic marketing recommendations effectively through executive presentations and technical research reports. (Aligned with PLO4 & PLO6)

Assessment Tools for Learning Outcome:

Learning Outcome	Assessment Criteria
Formulate precise marketing research problems and strategic hypotheses.	Mid-Term Test, Research Proposal Assignment, Class Participation
Design advanced quantitative survey instruments and experimental frameworks.	Research Instrument Design Assignment, Mid-Term Test
Conduct digital netnographic and social media sentiment analytics.	Social Listening Lab Assignment, Group Presentation
Apply advanced multivariate techniques (Conjoint, Cluster, MDS) to datasets.	Statistical Data Analysis Lab Reports, Final Exam
Interpret neurological and biometric research data (eye-tracking, EEG).	Neuromarketing Case Analysis, Class Presentation
Evaluate digital attribution and customer lifetime value (CLV) models.	Digital Analytics Assignment, Final Examination

Execute an end-to-end specialized marketing research consultancy project.	Comprehensive Research Term Project & Report
Demonstrate collaborative leadership in cross-functional research teams.	Group Project Peer Evaluations, Team Contribution Logs
Access and appraise contemporary academic journals and industry whitepapers.	Literature Review Assignment, Class Discussions
Communicate complex statistical findings and strategic recommendations.	Executive Research Presentation, Final Report

Pedagogy:

The course will be covered across 20 sessions of 90 minutes each, totaling 30 hours for this 3-credit advanced specialization course. The pedagogy blends advanced conceptual lectures, hands-on software analytics lab sessions (SPSS/R/Python modules), Harvard and Ivey marketing research case studies, netnography workshops, guest masterclasses from industry research heads (Kantar, NielsenIQ, Ipsos), and an applied research term project.

Session Plan:

Session Plan: 20 sessions of 90 minutes each, totaling 30 Hours for 3 Credit course.

S. No.	Topic	Pre-reading / Reference	Pedagogy
1	Advanced Marketing Intelligence & Decision Frameworks • Transitioning from generic BRM to specialized marketing research • Role of market research in omnichannel and AI-driven ecosystems	Malhotra et al., Chapter 1; HBR Article: 'Marketing Research That Works'	Lecture & Strategic Discussion
2	Problem Formulation & Research Brief Architecture • Translating marketing management dilemmas into research questions • Structuring the formal research proposal and hypothesis development	Malhotra et al., Chapter 2; Ivey Case: 'Research Problem Formulation in Global Brands'	Interactive Workshop & Case Analysis
3	Advanced Measurement & Psychometric Scale Construction • Designing multi-item scales for latent constructs (brand equity, loyalty) • Assessing reliability (Cronbach's Alpha) and validity (convergent/discriminant)	Hair et al., Multivariate Data Analysis - Measurement Chapters; Research Paper (Churchill, 1979)	Lecture & Software Lab (SPSS/R)

4	Advanced Survey Design & Experimental Research in Marketing • Questionnaire design pitfalls, psychographics, and projective techniques • Experimental designs: Between-subjects vs. within-subjects, field experiments	Malhotra et al., Chapters 7 & 8; HBR Article: 'The Surprising Power of Online Experiments'	Lecture & Design Lab
5	Digital Netnography & Online Community Intelligence • Conducting digital ethnography and qualitative mining of online forums • Analyzing user-generated content (UGC) for brand insights	Kozinets, 'Netnography: The Essential Guide'; Article: 'Netnography in Modern Marketing Research'	Workshop & Case Study
6	Social Listening & Sentiment Analysis Labs • Extracting unstructured data from social platforms (X, Instagram, Reddit) • Natural Language Processing (NLP) polarity scoring and brand sentiment tracking	Article: 'Social Media Analytics and Sentiment Mining' (Journal of Marketing Research)	Hands-on Software Lab
7	Advanced Market Segmentation (Factor & Cluster Analysis) • Uncovering latent consumer segments using Exploratory Factor Analysis (EFA) • Hierarchical and K-Means cluster analysis for psychographic segmentation	Hair et al., Chapter on Cluster Analysis; Case: 'Segmenting the Smartphone Market'	Lecture & Computer Lab
8	Conjoint Analysis for Product & Pricing Optimization • Designing attribute-based conjoint experiments (Full profile vs. Choice-based) • Estimating part-worth utilities, relative importance, and market share simulation	Green & Srinivasan, 'Conjoint Analysis in Consumer Research' (JMR); Software Tutorial	Lecture & Conjoint Lab
9	Brand Positioning & Multidimensional Scaling (MDS) • Mapping brand competitive landscapes using perceptual mapping • Attribute-based vs. non-attribute-based MDS techniques	Malhotra et al., Chapter on MDS; Case: 'Positioning Luxury Automobile Brands in Asia'	Lecture & Analysis Lab

10	Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) in Brand Equity Research • Testing complex causal models involving multiple independent and dependent constructs • Assessing measurement models and structural paths (CB-SEM vs. PLS-SEM)	Hair et al., 'Primer on Partial Least Squares Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM)'	Advanced Lecture & Demonstration
MID-TERM EXAMINATION			
11	Neuromarketing: Measuring Subconscious Consumer Responses • Introduction to consumer neuroscience and biometrics • Electroencephalography (EEG) and functional MRI (fMRI) in advertising pre-testing	Pradeep, 'The Buying Brain: Decoding Customer Psychology'; HBR: 'Neuromarketing: What You Need'	Lecture & Video Masterclass
12	Biometrics, Eye-Tracking & Facial Coding Labs • Measuring visual attention using eye-tracking heatmaps and gaze fixation • Analyzing micro-expressions and galvanic skin response (GSR) for emotional arousal	Article: 'Eye Tracking in Packaging and Retail Design' (Journal of Business Research)	Lab Demonstration & Workshop
13	Retail Analytics & Shopper Marketing Research • Path-to-purchase research, RFID tracking, and in-store shopper observation • Analyzing point-of-sale (POS) scanner data for elasticity and promotion response	Undheim et al., 'Shopper Marketing Research'; Case: 'Optimizing Retail Shelf Space'	Case Study & Discussion
14	Digital Attribution Modeling & Web Clickstream Analytics • Multi-touch attribution (MTA) models in digital marketing research • Analyzing bounce rates, conversion funnels, and programmatic ad effectiveness	HBR Article: 'The Truth About Customer Attribution'; Google Analytics Academy Whitepaper	Lecture & Digital Lab
15	Customer Lifetime Value (CLV) & Big Data Predictive Modeling • Estimating acquisition cost, retention rates, and forward-looking CLV • Predictive modeling for customer churn and cross-selling propensity	Gupta et al., 'Valuing Customers' (Journal of Marketing); Harvard Case: 'Calculating CLV'	Lecture & Quantitative Problem Solving

16	B2B Marketing Research & Industrial Buying Behavior • Key differences between consumer and B2B research methodologies • Expert interviews, Delphi technique, and organizational buying center analysis	Lilien et al., 'Industrial Marketing Research'; Article: 'Researching High-Stakes B2B Markets'	Lecture & Industry Case
17	Global & Cross-Cultural Marketing Research Challenges • Equivalence issues (linguistic, metric, and conceptual equivalence) in cross-border research • Adapting qualitative and quantitative instruments across emerging and developed markets	Malhotra et al., Chapter on International Marketing Research; HBR: 'Global Market Research Pitfalls'	Lecture & Discussion
18	AI-Powered Market Research & Synthetic Consumers • Leveraging generative AI and synthetic data panels in marketing research • Automated survey generation, synthetic focus groups, and ethical boundaries	Article: 'Generative AI and Synthetic Research' (MIT Sloan Management Review)	Seminar & Ethical Debate
19	Comprehensive Research Project Presentations (Part 1) • Student groups present primary data collection, advanced analytics, and strategic findings	Student Group Research Term Reports	Exec Presentations & Evaluation
20	Comprehensive Research Project Presentations (Part 2) & Course Synthesis • Final group presentations, industry critique, and future frontiers of marketing intelligence	Course Synthesis Notes & Research Deliverables	Presentations & Course Wrap-up
END-TERM EXAMINATION			

Recommended Text Book:

1. Malhotra, N. K., & Dash, S. (7th/8th Edition). Marketing Research: An Applied Orientation. Pearson Education.

2. Hair, J. F., Black, W. C., Babin, B. J., & Anderson, R. E. (8th Edition). Multivariate Data Analysis. Cengage Learning.

3. Churchill, G. A., & Iacobucci, D. (6th Edition). Marketing Research: Methodological Foundations. South-Western College Pub.

4. Aaker, D. A., Kumar, V., Leone, R. P., & Day, G. S. (12th Edition). Marketing Research. Wiley.

5. Pradeep, A. K. (2010). The Buying Brain: Decoding Customer Psychology with Neuromarketing. John Wiley & Sons.

Reference Text Books / Recourses (Journals, Internet Websites):

• Academic & Research Journals: Journal of Marketing Research (JMR), Journal of Marketing, Journal of Business Research, Harvard Business Review (HBR), MIT Sloan Management Review, and International Journal of Market Research.

• Netnography & Digital Research: Robert V. Kozinets, 'Netnography: The Essential Guide'; Digital ethnography toolkits and social listening case studies.

• MOOCs & Online Resources: Coursera / edX specialization modules on 'Digital Analytics for Marketing Professionals' (Northwestern University) and 'Neuromarketing and Consumer Neuroscience' (Copenhagen Business School); YouTube channels: NielsenIQ, Kantar Insights, and Wharton School Marketing Insights.

Course Evaluation:

Evaluation is a continuous process at SoIM. Students will be given individual/group projects/ assignments in advanced marketing research data analysis lab reports, survey design projects, and social listening labs. Keeping in line with continuous evaluation at SoIM, the evaluation scheme is as follows:

Areas	Weightage
(I) Continuous Evaluation: *(Quizzes: 10 Marks, Assignments, Group/Individual Projects: 30 Marks*	40%
(II) Mid Term Examination	20%
(III) Final Examination	40%
Total	**100 %**

*****